

My Claude Usage Strategy

Profile: **Student** | Activities: Coding, Research & Learning, Content Creation | Usage: Occasional | Need: Fast Answers

Coder

Researcher

Content
Creator

Occasional
User

RECOMMENDED PRIMARY MODEL

Haiku

Fast & Light

Quick definitions, grammar fixes, short code snippets, simple Q&A.; Best when speed matters more than depth.

Use when: speed > depth

Sonnet Best Fit

Best Fit

Your go-to model. Handles coding, research summaries, content drafts, and concept explanations fast.

Use when: 90% of your tasks

Opus

Deep Thinker

Complex essays, difficult algorithms, multi-step research synthesis. Use sparingly for high-stakes work.

Use when: high-stakes output

WHY SONNET FITS YOU

As a student who codes, researches, and creates content but only occasionally — you need a model smart enough to handle varied tasks without needing to switch constantly. Sonnet delivers near-Opus quality at far greater speed, perfect for fast answers. Since you are not a heavy user, it also gives you the most value per session.

EFFORT LEVEL GUIDE

Low

Quick lookups, vocabulary checks, short code fixes. Use when you just need a fast nudge.

Standard (Recommended)

Your default for almost everything: coding help, concept explanations, essay drafts, research summaries.

High

Important assignments, final project reviews, scholarship essays. Use when the stakes are higher.

Max

Thesis writing, capstone projects, complex debugging, anything graded or published. Use rarely.

PERSONALIZED WORKFLOW TABLE

Task	Best Model	Best Effort	Reason
Quick concept lookup	Haiku	Low	Speed matters; depth not needed
Debug code / fix errors	Sonnet	Standard	Needs reasoning; Haiku misses edge cases
Essay / assignment draft	Sonnet	Standard	Good quality without burning resources
Understand research paper	Sonnet	Standard	Summarize and explain in plain language
Build project / feature	Sonnet	High	Careful reasoning for multi-step code
Final exam / deep study	Sonnet	High	Needs nuance; accuracy is important
Thesis / capstone project	Opus	Max	Highest-stakes; invest in quality
Social caption / short post	Haiku	Low	Fast creative output; no depth needed

BIGGEST MISTAKES TO AVOID

No	Using Opus for every task — it is slower and overkill for daily student work
No	Using Max effort for everything — Standard effort handles 80% of tasks just fine
No	Submitting AI output without reviewing it — always verify code and facts
No	Giving vague prompts — the more context you provide, the better the answer
No	Using Haiku for complex code bugs — it often misses subtle logic errors

FINAL RECOMMENDATION

If you could only pick one:

Claude Sonnet + Standard effort

Sonnet at Standard effort covers 90% of what you will ever need as a student — fast enough for quick answers, smart enough for coding and research, and versatile enough for content creation. Save Opus + High or Max for your most important academic moments.